MATIZAR y ENFATIZAR

Hedging and emphasis · suavizar y reforzar

Nivel C2

Matizar (hedging) baja el volumen de una afirmación; enfatizar lo sube. Clave del inglés culto.

1 ¿Para qué matizar?

- hedging = matizar, suavizar
- emphasis = reforzar, subrayar
- Ajustar la afirmación a la evidencia
- Prudencia académica y cortesía

2 Verbos y modales

- seem / appear / tend + to + inf.
- It would appear that…
- may / might / could (well)
- is likely / unlikely to + inf.

3 Adverbios y cifras

- arguably · presumably · apparently
- to some extent · on the whole
- approximately · roughly · some 40%
- Distancia: is thought to · allegedly

4 Énfasis gramatical

- I did warn you! (¡Sí que te avisé!)
- the very idea · the CEO herself
- no doubt whatsoever · not at all
- Whatever do you mean?

5 Intensificadores

- by far the best · far better
- highly likely · deeply moved
- utterly wrong · bitterly cold
- absolutely + extremo: perfect, unique

7 Error común

✗ It is supposed that prices will rise.

✓ Prices are expected to rise.

«Se supone que» → sujeto + is expected / supposed to

6 Consejo rápido

- Un hedge por idea: no los acumules.
- ~~very unique~~ → truly unique
- Académico: highly; oral: really, so

Mini ejercicio

Completa con una palabra.
Complete with one word.

1. The data _____ to suggest a link.
2. I _____ lock the door, I promise!
3. This is by _____ the best option.
4. There is no proof _____.
5. It's highly _____ to rain later.

Explicación · Explanation

Lee cada recuadro despacio. Primero en español, luego en inglés. Read each box slowly: first in Spanish, then in English.

¿Qué es? · What is it?

En el inglés culto, la **fuerza** de una afirmación se regula con precisión. **Matizar** (hedging) consiste en **rebajar la rotundidad** de lo que decimos —por prudencia científica, por cortesía o para protegernos de la crítica—: **it would appear that…**, **arguably**, **to some extent**. **Enfatizar** es lo contrario: **reforzar** una idea con recursos gramaticales y léxicos: **I did warn you**, **by far**, **the very**, **whatsoever**, **utterly**. Un hablante C2 maneja ambos como un control de volumen: ni todo es seguro ni todo es dudoso.

Hedging **tones down** a claim (caution, politeness, academic precision); emphasis **turns it up**. A proficient writer controls both like a volume knob.

Afirmación + **hedge** → más cauta

Afirmación + **intensificador** → más rotunda

Antes de empezar: el registro · First of all: register

Académico y formal: it would appear, arguably, is thought to, highly, deeply, by far, whatsoever. **Oral e informal:** really, so, totally, kind of, sort of, I guess, loads better. No mezcles: ~~The results are totally awesome~~ no cabe en un ensayo. Para el énfasis por estructura (Never have I…, What matters is…) repasa C1-01 (inversión) y C1-02 (cleft sentences).

Academic: it would appear, arguably, highly, by far. Informal: really, so, totally, kind of. Keep them apart.

1 · Verbos que matizan · Hedging verbs

seem, **appear** y **tend** presentan la información como impresión o tendencia, no como un hecho probado. Con **would** la cautela aumenta: **it would seem / it would appear that…** es típico de artículos académicos e informes oficiales. Para referirnos al pasado usamos el infinitivo perfecto: **appears to have + participio**. También son verbos de cautela **suggest**, **indicate** y **point to**: los datos apuntan a, no demuestran.

seem / appear / tend to present information as impression or tendency. **Would** adds extra caution. For the past: **appear to have + past participle**.

Sujeto + seems / appears / tends + to + infinitivo

It + would seem / would appear + that + oración

Sujeto + appears to have + participio

The treatment **appears to** reduce symptoms in most patients.
→ El tratamiento parece reducir los síntomas en la mayoría de los pacientes.

It would seem that the original manuscript has been lost.
→ Todo parece indicar que el manuscrito original se ha perdido.

Investors **tend to** overreact to bad news.
→ Los inversores tienden a reaccionar en exceso ante las malas noticias.

MATIZAR y ENFATIZAR

Hedging and emphasis · suavizar y reforzar

📖 Explicación · Explanation | Nivel C2

2 · Modales y probabilidad · Modals and likelihood

🇪🇸 **may**, **might** y **could** rebajan la certeza; **may well / could well** equivalen a «es muy posible que». Para hablar de probabilidad con elegancia usamos **be likely / unlikely to** + infinitivo (¡nunca ~~is probable to~~!) o **there is a strong possibility that…**. **Should** expresa lo que es razonable esperar: The results **should** be available by May.

🇬🇧 **may / might / could** lower certainty; **may well** = it is quite possible. Use **be likely to**, never ~~be probable to~~. **Should** = what we reasonably expect.

Sujeto + may / might / could (well) + infinitivo

Sujeto + is (highly) likely / unlikely to + infinitivo

It is + likely / probable + that + oración

✊ The strike **may well** spread to other sectors.
→ Es muy posible que la huelga se extienda a otros sectores.

🏛️ Interest rates **are unlikely to** fall before the summer.
→ Es poco probable que los tipos de interés bajen antes del verano.

📊 These findings **could** have important implications for policy.
→ Estos hallazgos podrían tener implicaciones importantes para las políticas públicas.

3 · Distanciarse de la fuente · Distancing

🇪🇸 Cuando no queremos responsabilizarnos de una afirmación, la atribuimos a otros con la **pasiva impersonal** (vista en B2), que aquí funciona como recurso de cautela: **is thought / believed / said / reported / alleged to**. Es la marca del periodismo prudente. Con adverbios: **reportedly**, **allegedly**, **apparently**, **according to…**. Allegedly (presuntamente) es imprescindible en noticias judiciales: informa sin acusar.

🇬🇧 Attribute a claim to others to keep your distance: **is thought / said / reported / alleged to**, **reportedly**, **allegedly**.

Sujeto + is thought / said / alleged + to + infinitivo

Sujeto + is believed to have + participio

It is widely held / assumed + that…

🔥 The fire **is thought to have started** in the kitchen.
→ Se cree que el incendio empezó en la cocina.

💼 The senator **allegedly** accepted bribes from a construction firm.
→ El senador presuntamente aceptó sobornos de una constructora.

🏛️ **It is widely held that** the reform came too late.
→ Existe la opinión generalizada de que la reforma llegó demasiado tarde.

La escala de certeza · The certainty scale

Grado · Degree	Verbos y modales	Adverbios y adjetivos	Expresiones	Ejemplo · Example
✅ Certeza (100%)	will, must	certainly, undoubtedly, clearly	it is certain / clear that	Prices **will undoubtedly** rise.
🟢 Muy probable (90%)	will almost certainly	almost certainly, in all likelihood	is highly likely to	He **is highly likely to** win.
🟡 Probable (70%)	should, tend to	probably, presumably	is likely to · there is a good chance	It **should** be ready by May.

La escala de certeza · The certainty scale (continúa · cont.)

Grado · Degree	Verbos y modales	Adverbios y adjetivos	Expresiones	Ejemplo · Example
Posible (50%)	may, might, could (well)	possibly, perhaps, conceivably	it is possible that	The talks **may well** fail.
Poco probable (20%)	probably won't, may not	probably not, doubtful	is unlikely to · it is doubtful whether	She **is unlikely to** resign.
Casi imposible (≈0%)	can't, couldn't possibly	inconceivable	is highly unlikely to	That **can't** be true.

Elige el grado que permiten tus datos. Pero **no acumules** hedges: ~~*It might possibly perhaps be the case…*~~ suena evasivo. Uno o dos por afirmación es suficiente.

Choose the degree your evidence allows, but don't stack hedges: one or two per claim is enough.

4 · Adverbios y aproximadores · Hedging adverbs and approximators

arguably = «podría decirse que» (defendible, pero no indiscutible); **presumably** = «es de suponer que» (deducción lógica); **apparently / seemingly** = «al parecer, aparentemente»; **conceivably** = «cabe la posibilidad». Para limitar el alcance: **to some / a certain extent**, **in part**, **on the whole**, **broadly speaking**, **in most cases**. Con cifras, los **aproximadores**: **approximately**, **roughly**, **some** + número, **in the region of**, **upwards of**.

arguably, presumably, apparently soften claims; **to some extent, on the whole** limit their scope; **approximately, roughly, some** soften figures.

This is **arguably** the finest film of the decade.
→ Podría decirse que es la mejor película de la década.

To some extent, the crisis was self-inflicted.
→ Hasta cierto punto, la crisis fue autoinfligida.

The project will cost **in the region of** £40 million.
→ El proyecto costará alrededor de 40 millones de libras.

5 · DO / DID enfático · Emphatic do

En una oración afirmativa, añadir **do / does / did** (acentuado al hablar) delante del infinitivo refuerza la verdad de lo dicho. Sirve para **contradecir** (I **did** lock the door!), **insistir** o **conceder** (He **does** have a point.) y, en imperativos, para una invitación cálida y algo formal (**Do** sit down.). Equivale a «sí que…», «de verdad», «claro que». El verbo va siempre en **infinitivo sin to**: ~~*I did told you*~~.

do / does / did + bare infinitive (stressed) adds emphasis: contradicting, insisting, conceding, or warm imperatives (Do come in).

Sujeto + do / does / did + infinitivo sin to

Do + imperativo (invitación enfática)

I **did** send the report — check your spam folder.
→ Sí que mandé el informe: mira en la carpeta de spam.

The theory **does** have its limitations, admittedly.
→ Hay que reconocer que la teoría sí tiene sus limitaciones.

Do help yourself to coffee.
→ Sírvase café, por favor, con toda confianza.

6 · The very, -self, whatsoever, -ever · Emphatic words

🇪🇸 **the very + sustantivo** = «justo, mismísimo, mero»: the very thought (la mera idea), at that very moment (en ese preciso instante). El **reflexivo enfático** subraya la identidad: the CEO herself = la propia directora. En negativas, «en absoluto»: **no + sustantivo + whatsoever** (siempre detrás), **not… at all, not in the least**. En preguntas de sorpresa: **Whatever / However…?, Why ever…?** = «¿pero qué / cómo…?».

🇬🇧 **the very** + noun = exact / mere; emphatic **-self**; **no … whatsoever, not … at all**; surprise: **Whatever…? Why ever…?**

the very + sustantivo

no + sustantivo + whatsoever

Whatever / However / Why ever + aux. + sujeto…?

😟 **The very** idea of moving abroad terrified her.
→ La mera idea de mudarse al extranjero la aterraba.

🤦 The company has shown **no** interest **whatsoever** in our proposal.
→ La empresa no ha mostrado interés alguno por nuestra propuesta.

🎤 The Prime Minister **herself** opened the debate.
→ La propia primera ministra abrió el debate.

🤨 **Whatever** made you say that?
→ ¿Pero qué te llevó a decir eso?

VERY o ABSOLUTELY · Gradable vs non-gradable

🇪🇸 Los adjetivos **graduables** (good, cold, tired) admiten **very / extremely / incredibly**. Los **extremos o absolutos** (perfect, freezing, unique, exhausted) ya expresan el máximo: solo admiten **absolutely / utterly / totally / completely**. **Really** vale para ambos. **Quite** cambia de significado: quite good = bastante bueno; quite extraordinary = absolutamente extraordinario.

🇬🇧 Gradable adjectives take **very / extremely**; extreme or absolute ones take **absolutely / utterly / totally**. **Quite** = fairly (gradable) or completely (absolute).

📈 Graduables

- very / extremely good
- incredibly cold
- highly unusual
- ~~absolutely big~~

TOP Extremos

- absolutely perfect
- utterly exhausted
- truly unique
- ~~very unique~~

⚠️ quite / really

- quite good = bastante
- quite impossible = del todo
- really good · really perfect
- quite right = toda la razón

Intensificadores y sus collocations · Intensifiers and collocations

Intensificador	Se combina con	Ejemplo · Example	Español
utterly	ridiculous, wrong, exhausted, devastated	an utterly ridiculous claim	una afirmación totalmente ridícula
highly	likely, unlikely, recommended, qualified, controversial	a highly controversial ruling	una sentencia muy polémica
deeply	concerned, moved, rooted, divided, regret	a deeply divided society	una sociedad profundamente dividida
bitterly	disappointed, cold, opposed, resent	bitterly disappointed fans	aficionados amargamente decepcionados
fully	aware, booked, understand, appreciate	I am fully aware of the risks.	soy plenamente consciente
strongly	recommend, advise, oppose, believe	We strongly advise booking early.	aconsejamos encarecidamente
painfully	slow, shy, aware, obvious	progress was painfully slow	el avance fue desesperadamente lento
vitally	important	It is vitally important to act now.	es de vital importancia
greatly	appreciate, improve, exaggerate	Your help is greatly appreciated.	se agradece enormemente
by far / easily	+ superlativo	by far the best option	con diferencia, la mejor opción
far / much	+ comparativo	far more expensive	mucho más caro
ever	superlativo + ever	the best novel ever written	la mejor novela jamás escrita
such / so	such (a) + sustantivo · so + adjetivo	such a mess · so dull	tal desastre · tan aburrido
utter / sheer	+ sustantivo: nonsense, chaos, luck	sheer luck · utter chaos	pura suerte · caos absoluto

Son **collocations** fijas: ~~highly moved~~, ~~deeply recommended~~ o ~~bitterly aware~~ suenan extraños a un nativo. **By far** va delante del superlativo; delante de un comparativo, **far / much**: ~~by far better~~ → **far better**.

These are fixed collocations. **By far** + superlative; **far / much** + comparative.

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📖 Explicación · Explanation | Nivel C2

Rotundo o académico · Blunt vs academic

El inglés académico y el periodismo de calidad prefieren afirmaciones **calibradas**: no dicen menos, dicen **exactamente lo que los datos permiten**. Compara cada afirmación rotunda con su versión matizada.

Academic and quality journalistic English calibrate every claim to the evidence.

🗣️ Rotundo · blunt

- Social media **makes** teenagers depressed.
- This policy **failed**.
- **Everybody knows** diets don't work.
- Half the students failed.
- The author is **wrong**.

🎓 Matizado · hedged

- Heavy social media use **may contribute to** depression among teenagers.
- **It would appear that** the policy **has not achieved** its aims.
- **There is growing evidence that** most diets **tend to** fail in the long term.
- **Approximately** half the students failed.
- The author's argument is, **arguably**, flawed **in several respects**.

Texto modelo: un abstract · Model text

Fíjate en cómo este resumen de un artículo científico combina **cautela** (en azul) con **énfasis** (en rojo) allí donde la evidencia es sólida. «Este estudio examina… Los resultados parecen indicar que hablar dos idiomas desde la infancia puede, hasta cierto punto, retrasar el deterioro cognitivo. El efecto fue, con diferencia, más acusado entre… Aunque la muestra es relativamente pequeña, los datos sí respaldan…»

This study examines the relationship between early bilingualism and cognitive ageing. The results **would appear to suggest** that speaking two languages from childhood **may**, **to some extent**, delay the onset of age-related decline. The effect was **by far** the most pronounced among participants who used both languages daily. Although the sample is **relatively** small and the findings **should** be interpreted with caution, the data **do** support the view that bilingualism is **highly** unlikely to be cognitively neutral.

¿Cómo calibro una afirmación? · How do I calibrate a claim?

1. ¿Qué **demuestran** de verdad tus datos: certeza, tendencia o posibilidad?
   What does the evidence really show?
2. Elige **un** recurso del grado justo: **tends to, is likely to, may…**
   Pick one device of the right degree.
3. ¿No es tu afirmación? **Distánciate**: is thought to, reportedly.
   Not your claim? Keep your distance.
4. Limita el alcance: **to some extent, in most cases.**
   Limit the scope.
5. Si la evidencia es sólida, **enfatiza**: by far, the data **do** show.
   Strong evidence? Emphasise.
6. Relee: **¿más de dos hedges** por frase? Elimina los sobrantes.
   More than two hedges? Cut.

Más ejemplos · More examples

- Sales **appear to have peaked** in the third quarter.
  → Las ventas parecen haber tocado techo en el tercer trimestre.
- The virus **is believed to have originated** in bats.
  → Se cree que el virus se originó en murciélagos.
- **Presumably**, the committee will publish its report before the election.
  → Es de suponer que la comisión publicará su informe antes de las elecciones.
- Some readers **may** find the ending **somewhat** abrupt.
  → Puede que a algunos lectores el final les resulte algo abrupto.
- The figures are, **broadly speaking**, in line with expectations.
  → Las cifras están, a grandes rasgos, en línea con lo previsto.
- It was **by far** the most difficult decision of my career.
  → Fue, con diferencia, la decisión más difícil de mi carrera.
- The new engine is **far** more efficient than its predecessor.
  → El nuevo motor es mucho más eficiente que su predecesor.
- I **do** wish you had told me earlier.
  → Ojalá me lo hubieras dicho antes, de verdad.
- She was **utterly** devastated by the news.
  → La noticia la dejó completamente destrozada.
- That was **the very last** thing we expected.
  → Era lo último que nos esperábamos.
- **However** did you manage to get tickets?
  → ¿Pero cómo has conseguido entradas?
- The decision was **deeply** unpopular, and **rightly so**.
  → La decisión fue profundamente impopular, y con razón.

¡Caza al monstruo! · Hunt the monster

Monstruo del error

✗ ~~This method is very unique.~~
✓ This method is **unique**. / **truly** unique.
Unique es absoluto: sin very. / Non-gradable.

✗ ~~It is supposed that the economy will grow.~~
✓ The economy **is expected to** grow.
Calco de «se supone que». / Subject + be expected to.

✗ ~~Inflation is probable to rise.~~
✓ Inflation **is likely to** rise.
Probable no admite to + infinitivo. / Use likely to.

✗ ~~I am totally agree with you.~~
✓ I **totally agree** with you.
Agree es verbo: sin am. / No be.

✗ ~~She was very furious.~~
✓ She was **absolutely** furious.
Adjetivo extremo → absolutely. / Extreme adjective.

✗ ~~The results are too much important.~~
✓ The results are **extremely** important.
Too = demasiado; nunca too much + adj. / Not too much.

✗ ~~In a certain way, the data could perhaps suggest it.~~
✓ **To some extent**, the data **suggest** this.
Calco y exceso de hedges: suena evasivo. / Over-hedging.

✗ ~~I did told you the truth!~~
✓ I **did tell** you the truth!
Tras did enfático, infinitivo. / Bare infinitive.

Ejercicios · Practice

Escribe con lápiz y letra clara. Antes de escribir, piensa qué regla toca. Write in pencil. Think about the rule first.

Name · Nombre _____ Date · Fecha _____ Score _____

Ejercicio 1 ¿Matiza o enfatiza? · Hedge or emphasis?

Clasifica cada expresión: ¿rebaja la fuerza de una afirmación (hedging) o la refuerza (emphasis)?

Sort the expressions: do they soften or strengthen a claim?

Word bank: tends to · to some extent · herself · I did warn you · by far · is thought to · easily the best · may well · whatsoever · approximately · the very · arguably · utterly · it would appear · not in the least · presumably

Hedging	Emphasis

Ejercicio 2 Rodea la correcta · Circle the correct option

Rodea la opción correcta. Piensa en la collocation y en el registro.

Circle the correct option.

1. This is **by far** / very far the most thorough study to date.
2. There is no evidence **whatsoever** / in the least to support the claim.
3. It was **very** / absolutely freezing outside.

Ejercicio 2 Rodea la correcta · Circle the correct option (continúa · cont.)

4. She was **deeply** / highly moved by his speech.
5. The proposal is highly / **deeply** unlikely to succeed.
6. Inflation is **likely** / probable to rise further next year.
7. The minister is **said** / told to be considering resignation.
8. I **do** / am appreciate everything you have done.
9. The **very** / much thought of it makes me shudder.
10. Prices have risen by **roughly** / rough 12% this year.
11. He **did** / was say he would be late — you just weren't listening.
12. The two approaches are **entirely** / bitterly different.

Ejercicio 3 — Une con su equivalente · Match with the Spanish equivalent

Une cada hedge con su equivalente en español.
Match each hedge with its Spanish equivalent.

1 it would appear that	a podría decirse que
2 arguably	b todo parece indicar que
3 presumably	c hasta cierto punto
4 to some extent	d alrededor de (cifras)
5 tends to	e presuntamente
6 may well	f es muy posible que
7 allegedly	g suele
8 in the region of	h es de suponer que

Ejercicio 4 — Collocations de intensidad · Intensifier collocations

Une cada intensificador con la palabra con la que forma una collocation natural.
Match each intensifier with its natural collocate.

1 utterly	a asleep
2 bitterly	b ridiculous
3 deeply	c cold
4 highly	d awake
5 painfully	e booked
6 fully	f shy
7 wide	g rooted
8 fast	h recommended

Ejercicio 5 — ¿Verdadero o falso? · True or false?

¿Es verdadera o falsa cada afirmación sobre el uso? Si es falsa, corrígela.
Are these statements about usage true or false?

1. Very unique is acceptable in formal writing. T F
2. Emphatic do / does / did is followed by the bare infinitive. T F
3. By far is typically placed before a superlative: by far the best. T F
4. Whatsoever is normally used in affirmative sentences. T F
5. Presumably expresses absolute certainty. T F

Ejercicio 5 ¿Verdadero o falso? · True or false? (continúa · cont.)

6 Arguably means that a claim is probably false. T F

7 Stacking several hedges in one sentence can make a writer sound evasive. T F

8 Highly collocates naturally with likely, recommended and qualified. T F

9 Quite impossible means «bastante imposible». T F

10 The very + noun means «muy» + noun. T F

11 Is probable to + infinitive is incorrect. T F

Ejercicio 6 Completa con el hedge · Complete with a hedge

Completa con una palabra del recuadro. Usa cada una una vez. Fíjate en las pistas del contexto.
Complete with a word from the box. Use each word once.

Word bank: appear · tend · likely · seemingly · arguably · extent · presumably · suggest · may · thought

1 As a rule, older patients _____ to respond less well to this treatment.

2 At first sight, the two phenomena _____ to be closely related.

3 The new regulations are highly _____ to come into force next spring.

Ejercicio 6 Completa con el hedge · Complete with a hedge (continúa · cont.)

4 After months of _____ endless negotiations, a deal was finally reached.

5 This is, _____, the most influential novel of the decade.

6 To some _____, the crisis was self-inflicted.

7 As he is a lawyer, he was, _____, aware of the legal risks.

8 The data _____ that the policy has had only a modest impact.

9 The results _____ well have been distorted by the small sample.

10 The suspect is widely _____ to have fled the country.

Ejercicio 7 Sube el volumen · Turn up the volume

Completa con una palabra o expresión enfática del recuadro. Usa cada una una vez.
Complete with an emphatic word from the box. Use each one once.

Word bank: by far · whatsoever · very · did · does · herself · at all · ever · such · so

1 I _____ lock the door — someone must have forced it.

2 There is no evidence _____ to support the allegations.

3 She is _____ the most gifted pianist of her generation.

4 At that _____ moment, the lights went out.

5 Ms Ortega _____ signed the letter, not her secretary.

6 Why _____ did you agree to that plan?

Ejercicio 7 — Sube el volumen · Turn up the volume (continúa · cont.)

7 It was _____ a glorious afternoon that we ate outside.

8 I disagree with him, but he _____ have a point.

9 I wasn't _____ surprised by the verdict.

10 The lecture was _____ dull that half the audience left.

Ejercicio 8 — Familias de palabras · Word families

✍️ Completa la tabla con la forma que falta. Si no existe, la casilla lleva un guion (—).
Complete the table with the missing forms.

Verbo · Verb	Adjetivo · Adjective	Adverbio · Adverb	Sustantivo · Noun
appear			appearance
seem		seemingly	—
argue			
presume	presumable		
—		probably	
—	likely	(most) likely	
—			possibility
tend	—	—	
allege			allegation

Ejercicio 9 Lee y analiza · Read and analyse

✍️ Lee el artículo. Marca T (true) o F (false) y contesta las preguntas sobre los recursos de matiz y énfasis.
🇬🇧 Read the article. Tick T or F and answer the questions.

Does remote work really make us more productive?

Few workplace changes have been as rapid, or as hotly debated, as the shift to remote working. Early studies appeared to show that employees working from home were, on the whole, more productive than their office-based colleagues. More recent research, however, would seem to paint a rather more complicated picture.

According to a large survey published last year, productivity tends to rise for routine, individual tasks but may well fall when work depends on close collaboration. Managers, for their part, are thought to underestimate the output of staff they cannot see. The survey is by far the most comprehensive to date, yet its authors themselves concede that their conclusions are, to some extent, provisional.

What the data do show, quite unambiguously, is that employees value flexibility above almost everything else. Arguably, the very notion of a fixed nine-to-five day has been called into question. Whether companies will embrace this is, presumably, a matter of trust rather than technology. There is no evidence whatsoever that forcing staff back to the office five days a week improves results — although, as one economist drily put it, 'absence of evidence is not evidence of absence'.

1. Early studies suggested that home workers were generally more productive. T F
2. The survey found that productivity rises for highly collaborative work. T F
3. The authors present their conclusions as final. T F
4. There is clear evidence that full-time office attendance improves results. T F
5. Find three hedging expressions in paragraph 1.

6. Which phrase in paragraph 2 reports a belief without the writer endorsing it?

7. Find four devices of emphasis in the text.

Ejercicio 9 Lee y analiza · Read and analyse (continúa · cont.)

8 Why does the writer use presumably in paragraph 3?

9 What does the economist's remark add to the final claim?

Ejercicio 10 Ordena la frase · Put the words in order

Ordena las fichas para formar frases matizadas o enfáticas.
Put the tiles in order to make hedged or emphatic sentences.

1 would | it | that | appear | the sample | was | incomplete

2 by far | this | the most | is | ambitious | project | to date

3 warn | I | you | did | about | the risks

4 whatsoever | no | there | doubt | is | about his guilt

5 thought | the president | is | to have | the capital | left

Ejercicio 10 Ordena la frase · Put the words in order (continúa · cont.)

6 tend | younger voters | less loyal | be | to | to a single party

7 very | the | of it | idea | absurd | is

8 do | mean | whatever | by that | you | ?

9 herself | the minister | that | admitted | were wrong | the figures

Ejercicio 11 Caza el error · Find the mistake

✍️ Cada frase tiene UN error de matiz, de énfasis o de collocation. Escríbela correctamente.
🇬🇧 Each sentence has ONE mistake. Write it correctly.

1 ✗ This solution is very unique.
✓ _____

2 ✗ It is supposed that the economy will grow next year.
✓ _____

3 ✗ Inflation is probable to fall in the coming months.
✓ _____

4 ✗ I did told you the truth!
✓ _____

5 ✗ She was very furious about the decision.
✓ _____

6 ✗ He showed whatsoever no remorse.
✓ _____

7 ✗ I am totally agree with your analysis.
✓ _____

8 ✗ The results are too much important to ignore.
✓ _____

Ejercicio 11 Caza el error · Find the mistake (continúa · cont.)

9 ✗ Her latest novel is by far better than her first.
✓ _____

10 ✗ The candidate is high qualified for the post.
✓ _____

Ejercicio 12 Quita los hedges sobrantes · Cut the over-hedging

✍️ Estas frases están sobre-matizadas y suenan evasivas. Reescríbelas con UN solo recurso de cautela (o dos, como máximo).
🇬🇧 These sentences are over-hedged. Rewrite them with one hedge (two at most).

1 It might possibly perhaps be the case that prices could rise.
_____

2 In a certain way, the data seem to more or less indicate a trend.
_____

3 It would seem that it is perhaps possible that the drug may help.
_____

4 Arguably, it could be suggested that the novel is possibly his best.
_____

5 There may perhaps be a possibility that the talks might fail.
_____

6 It is thought by some that the painting may perhaps have been stolen.
_____

Ejercicio 13 De rotundo a académico · From blunt to academic

Reescribe cada afirmación rotunda en un registro académico y prudente. Usa los recursos indicados entre paréntesis.
Rewrite each blunt claim in a cautious academic style, using the devices given.

1. Social media makes teenagers depressed. (may · contribute to)
2. This policy has failed. (it would appear)
3. Everyone knows that the climate is changing. (widely accepted)
4. Rich people live longer. (tend to)
5. The government lied about the figures. (appear · to have)
6. Unemployment will rise next year. (likely)
7. Half of the participants dropped out. (approximately)
8. The author's argument is wrong. (arguably · flawed)
9. The minister knew about the deal. (alleged · to have)

Ejercicio 14 Traduce al inglés · Translate into English

Traduce usando un recurso de matiz o de énfasis. ¡Nada de calcos!
Translate using a hedging or emphatic device. No calques!

1. Al parecer, el acusado ya había salido del país.
2. Es, podría decirse, la mejor película del año.
3. Los jóvenes suelen votar menos que sus mayores.
4. Es muy posible que la reunión se aplace.
5. Se cree que el cuadro fue pintado en Sevilla.
6. Es, con diferencia, el mejor restaurante de la ciudad.
7. ¡Sí que te avisé!
8. No tengo intención alguna de dimitir.
9. Eres justo la persona que estaba buscando.

Ejercicio 14 Traduce al inglés · Translate into English (continúa · cont.)

10 🇪🇸 La propia ministra reconoció el error.

🇬🇧 _____

11 🇪🇸 Hasta cierto punto, la crisis era previsible.

🇬🇧 _____

12 🇪🇸 Estaba profundamente preocupada por las consecuencias.

🇬🇧 _____

Ejercicio 15 Ahora escribe tú · Your turn

✍️ Escribe frases propias. Cuida el registro: académico, periodístico o formal.
🇬🇧 Write your own sentences. Mind the register.

1 Matiza esta afirmación con al menos **dos** hedges: Video games cause violence.

_____

_____

2 Contradice con **do / did enfático**: You never listen to me.

_____

3 Escribe sobre tu ciudad con **by far** + superlativo y un adjetivo extremo con **absolutely**.

_____

_____

Ejercicio 15 Ahora escribe tú · Your turn (continúa · cont.)

4 Escribe la primera frase de un informe con **It would appear that** y **to some extent**.

_____

_____

5 Escribe una frase de queja formal con **deeply** y **whatsoever**.

_____

_____

6 Redacta una noticia breve (2 frases) con **allegedly** y **is thought to**.

_____

_____

Ejercicio 16 Transformaciones (Cambridge C2) · Key word transformations

✍️ Completa la segunda frase para que signifique lo mismo que la primera. Usa la palabra clave (entre paréntesis) sin cambiarla y entre 3 y 8 palabras.
🇬🇧 Complete the second sentence so that it means the same as the first. Use the key word unchanged and 3–8 words.

1 People believe that the painting was stolen in 1911.
→ The painting _____ in 1911. (BELIEVED)

2 It seems that the company has underestimated the risks.
→ The company _____ the risks. (APPEARS)

3 No other restaurant in town is anywhere near as good as this one.
→ This is _____ restaurant in town. (FAR)

4 He showed absolutely no remorse.
→ He showed _____. (WHATSOEVER)

5 You're right that I promised to call you, but I forgot.
→ I _____ you, but I forgot. (DID)

Ejercicio 16 Transformaciones (Cambridge C2) · Key word transformations (continúa · cont.)

6 It is highly probable that the talks will collapse within days.
→ The talks _____ within days. (LIKELY)

7 Just thinking about the exam made me nervous.
→ The _____ the exam made me nervous. (VERY)

8 Apparently, the minister knew nothing about the deal.
→ The minister _____ nothing about the deal. (SEEMS)

¿Lo he aprendido? · Can I do it?

Marca cada frase cuando la sepas hacer y colorea las estrellas. Tick each line when you can do it and colour the stars.

Lo sé hacer · I can...

- ☐ Sé matizar con **seem, appear, tend to** y **it would appear that**. ☆☆☆
  I can hedge with seem, appear, tend to and it would appear that.
- ☐ Gradúo la certeza con **may well, is likely to, presumably, arguably**. ☆☆☆
  I can grade certainty with may well, is likely to, presumably, arguably.
- ☐ Me distancio de una fuente con **is thought to, allegedly, reportedly**. ☆☆☆
  I can distance myself from a source.
- ☐ Uso el **do / did enfático**, **the very**, el **-self** enfático y **whatsoever**. ☆☆☆
  I use emphatic do, the very, emphatic -self and whatsoever.
- ☐ Combino intensificadores con naturalidad: **highly likely, deeply moved, by far the best**. ☆☆☆
  I use natural intensifier collocations.
- ☐ Nunca escribo ~~very unique~~, ~~is probable to~~ ni ~~It is supposed that~~. ☆☆☆
  I never write very unique, is probable to or It is supposed that.
- ☐ Ajusto el registro: no sobre-matizo ni uso so / really / totally en textos académicos. ☆☆☆
  I adjust the register: no over-hedging, no informal intensifiers in academic texts.

Mi progreso · My progress

Colorea 1, 2 o 3 estrellas en cada ejercicio. Colour 1, 2 or 3 stars for each exercise.

Ej. 1 ☆☆☆	Ej. 2 ☆☆☆	Ej. 3 ☆☆☆	Ej. 4 ☆☆☆
Ej. 5 ☆☆☆	Ej. 6 ☆☆☆	Ej. 7 ☆☆☆	Ej. 8 ☆☆☆
Ej. 9 ☆☆☆	Ej. 10 ☆☆☆	Ej. 11 ☆☆☆	Ej. 12 ☆☆☆
Ej. 13 ☆☆☆	Ej. 14 ☆☆☆	Ej. 15 ☆☆☆	Ej. 16 ☆☆☆

Solucionario · Answer key

Para el adulto que corrige (¡o para comprobar después de hacerlo!). For the grown-up who checks, or to check after you finish.

Mapa · Mini ejercicio

1. appear / seem · 2. did · 3. far · 4. whatsoever · 5. likely

Ejercicio 1 · ¿Matiza o enfatiza?

🔽 **Hedging:** arguably, it would appear, to some extent, tends to, presumably, may well, approximately, is thought to

🔼 **Emphasis:** by far, whatsoever, the very, utterly, I did warn you, herself, not in the least, easily the best

Ejercicio 2 · Rodea la correcta

1. by far · 2. whatsoever · 3. absolutely · 4. deeply · 5. highly · 6. likely · 7. said · 8. do · 9. very · 10. roughly · 11. did · 12. entirely

Ejercicio 3 · Une con su equivalente

1-b · 2-a · 3-h · 4-c · 5-g · 6-f · 7-e · 8-d

Ejercicio 4 · Collocations de intensidad

1-b · 2-c · 3-g · 4-h · 5-f · 6-e · 7-d · 8-a

Ejercicio 5 · ¿Verdadero o falso?

1. False ✗ — Unique is non-gradable: **truly unique** or just **unique**.
2. True ✓
3. True ✓
4. False ✗ — It follows **no / any / nothing** in negative contexts.
5. False ✗ — It expresses a logical assumption: «es de suponer».
6. False ✗ — It means the claim can reasonably be defended.

Ejercicio 5 · ¿Verdadero o falso? (continúa · cont.)

7. True ✓
8. True ✓
9. False ✗ — With absolute adjectives, quite = completely: «del todo imposible».
10. False ✗ — It means «justo, mismísimo, mero»: the very moment.
11. True ✓ — Use **is likely to** or **it is probable that**.

Ejercicio 6 · Completa con el hedge

1. tend · 2. appear · 3. likely · 4. seemingly · 5. arguably · 6. extent · 7. presumably · 8. suggest · 9. may · 10. thought

Ejercicio 7 · Sube el volumen

1. did · 2. whatsoever · 3. by far · 4. very · 5. herself · 6. ever · 7. such · 8. does · 9. at all · 10. so

Ejercicio 8 · Familias de palabras

Verbo · Verb	Adjetivo · Adjective	Adverbio · Adverb	Sustantivo · Noun
appear	apparent	apparently	appearance
seem	seeming	seemingly	—
argue	arguable	arguably	argument
presume	presumable	presumably	presumption
—	probable	probably	probability
—	likely	(most) likely	likelihood
—	possible	possibly	possibility
tend	—	—	tendency
allege	alleged	allegedly	allegation

Ejercicio 9 · Lee y analiza

1. True ✓
2. False ✗ — It tends to rise for routine, individual tasks and may well fall for collaborative work.
3. False ✗ — They concede their conclusions are, to some extent, provisional.
4. False ✗ — There is no evidence whatsoever that it does.
5. appeared to show · on the whole · would seem to · rather
6. are thought to (underestimate)
7. by far · themselves · do show · quite unambiguously · the very notion · whatsoever
8. To present a logical inference, not a proven fact.
9. A further hedge: the lack of evidence does not prove that office attendance never improves results.

Ejercicio 10 · Ordena la frase

1. It would appear that the sample was incomplete.
2. This is by far the most ambitious project to date.
3. I did warn you about the risks.
4. There is no doubt whatsoever about his guilt.
5. The president is thought to have left the capital.
6. Younger voters tend to be less loyal to a single party.
7. The very idea of it is absurd.
8. Whatever do you mean by that?
9. The minister herself admitted that the figures were wrong.

Ejercicio 11 · Caza el error

1. This solution is unique. / This solution is truly unique.
2. The economy is expected to grow next year. / The economy is supposed to grow next year.
3. Inflation is likely to fall in the coming months. / It is probable that inflation will fall in the coming months.
4. I did tell you the truth!
5. She was absolutely furious about the decision. / She was furious about the decision.
6. He showed no remorse whatsoever.

Ejercicio 11 · Caza el error (continúa · cont.)

7. I totally agree with your analysis.
8. The results are far too important to ignore. / The results are too important to ignore.
9. Her latest novel is far better than her first. / Her latest novel is much better than her first.
10. The candidate is highly qualified for the post.

Ejercicio 12 · Quita los hedges sobrantes

1. Prices **may well** rise. / Prices **are likely to** rise.
2. The data **appear to** indicate a trend. / The data **suggest** a trend.
3. The drug **may** help. / **It would appear that** the drug can help.
4. The novel is **arguably** his best.
5. The talks **may well** fail. / **There is a possibility that** the talks will fail.
6. The painting **is thought to have been** stolen.

Ejercicio 13 · De rotundo a académico

1. Social media use **may contribute to** depression among teenagers.
2. **It would appear that** this policy has failed.
3. **It is widely accepted that** the climate is changing.
4. Wealthier people **tend to** live longer. / Rich people **tend to** live longer.
5. The government **appears to have** misrepresented the figures. / The government **appears to have** lied about the figures.
6. Unemployment **is likely to** rise next year. / **It is likely that** unemployment will rise next year.
7. **Approximately** half of the participants dropped out.
8. The author's argument is **arguably flawed**.
9. The minister **is alleged to have known** about the deal.

MATIZAR y ENFATIZAR

Hedging and emphasis · suavizar y reforzar

🔑 **Solucionario** · Answer key

Nivel C2

Ejercicio 14 · Traduce al inglés

1. The defendant appears to have already left the country. / Apparently, the defendant had already left the country.
2. It is arguably the best film of the year.
3. Young people tend to vote less than their elders.
4. The meeting may well be postponed. / The meeting could well be postponed.
5. The painting is believed to have been painted in Seville. / The picture is thought to have been painted in Seville.
6. It is by far the best restaurant in the city. / It is by far the best restaurant in town.
7. I did warn you!
8. I have no intention whatsoever of resigning. / I have no intention of resigning at all.
9. You are the very person I was looking for.
10. The minister herself acknowledged the mistake. / The minister herself admitted the mistake.
11. To some extent, the crisis was foreseeable. / To a certain extent, the crisis was predictable.
12. She was deeply concerned about the consequences.

Ejercicio 15 · Ahora escribe tú

1. Ej.: There would appear to be some evidence that violent video games may, in certain cases, contribute to aggressive behaviour.
2. Ej.: I do listen to you — I just don't always agree with you.
3. Ej.: Granada is by far the most beautiful city I know; the Alhambra at sunset is absolutely breathtaking.
4. Ej.: It would appear that, to some extent, the new timetable has improved punctuality.
5. Ej.: I am deeply disappointed that I have received no explanation whatsoever for the delay.
6. Ej.: The businessman allegedly transferred €2 million to an offshore account. He is thought to have left the country last week.

Ejercicio 16 · Transformaciones (Cambridge C2)

1. The painting **is believed to have been stolen** in 1911.
2. The company **appears to have underestimated** the risks.
3. This is **by far the best** restaurant in town. / This is **far and away the best** restaurant in town.
4. He showed **no remorse whatsoever**.
5. I **did promise to call** you, but I forgot.
6. The talks **are highly likely to collapse** within days. / The talks **are very likely to collapse** within days.
7. The **very thought of** the exam made me nervous.
8. The minister **seems to have known** nothing about the deal.